

Layout Best Practices

Panels

A Panel represents an area of the Screen, and it can be divided into Sub-Panels if necessary. A Panel is used to display the content of one or several Views in a specific location of the Screen. It can have a specific height or width, or it can be auto-sized.

The name of a Panel should be meaningful enough to illustrate its position or role. A Layout can be composed of the following Panels:

- ▶ SUB_HEADER
- ▶ TITLE
- ▶ TABS
- ▶ FILTERS
- ▶ CONTEXT
- ▶ FOOTER

Defining the following Panels is recommended:

- ▶ At least one CONTEXT Panel to display the runtime information
 - ▷ The CONTEXT Panel can be divided into Sub-Panels, which will determine the complexity of the Screen (that is, SIMPLE or not)
- ▶ All other Panels are optional but may be required in some situations to ensure User Interface consistency across the solution (e.g., a section for displaying as the Screen title whatever is displayed in the CONTEXT Panel)

If you need a Layout with additional Panels or a Layout that will use a height or width for each Panel that is different from those of the Layouts that already exist, you have to create a new one.

To display a single View on the entire Screen, the Layout should consist of one Panel positioned at the top-left corner and which is sized to 100% of the screen. However, in most cases, multiple Panels will be used. For that reason, any larger Panel can be divided into several smaller sub-panels.

Panel Settings in Layout Definition

- ▶ When setting up a new Layout, use a fixed size for the Panels such as SUB_HEADER, TITLE, and FOOTER, as the View for those Panels should have a constant size
- ▶ The main level of the Layout should contain one Panel with size set to "Auto" for the CONTEXT in most cases
- ▶ When splitting CONTEXT into Sub-Panels, use percentage for size instead of pixels whenever possible for the purpose of resizing the Screen for different device resolutions

Create a separate Panel in the Layout only if the content of the Panel changes depending on the Screen or context.

Panel Naming Conventions

- ▶ When describing the vertical positions of these Panels, you could use:

- ▶ The LEFT and RIGHT suffixes when there are two Sub-Panels
- ▶ The LEFT, CENTER, and RIGHT suffixes when there are three Sub-Panels
- ▶ The 1,2,3,4... suffixes for Panels where 1 represents the Panel closest to the left of the parent
- ▶ In another example, the CONTEXT Panel could be split into three horizontal Sub-Panels, in which case there would be:
 - ▶ CONTEXT – the parent Panel
 - ▶ CONTEXT_TOP – the child horizontal Panel
 - ▶ CONTEXT_MIDDLE – the second child horizontal Panel
 - ▶ CONTEXT_BOTTOM – the third child horizontal Panel
- ▶ When describing the horizontal positions of these Panels, you could use:
 - ▶ The TOP and BOTTOM suffixes when there are two Sub-Panels
 - ▶ The TOP, MIDDLE, and BOTTOM suffixes when there are three Sub-Panels
 - ▶ The A,B,C,D... suffixes where A represent the Panel closest to the top of the parent
- ▶ A suffix can be inherited from a parent, which means that with more complicated Layouts, the Panel names could be, for example: CONTEXT_TOP_LEFT, CONTEXT_MIDDLE_RIGHT

Layout Naming Conventions

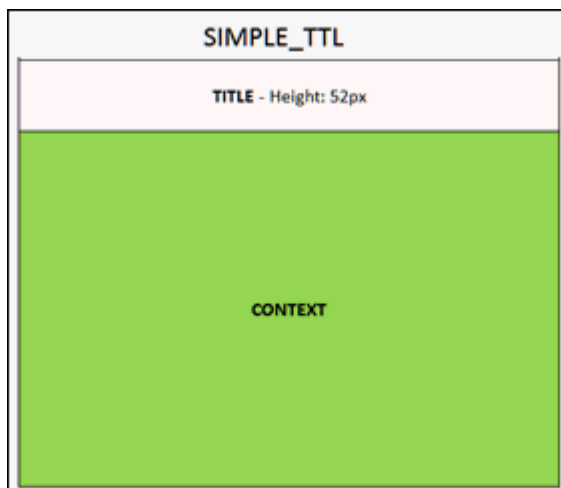
The Layout name cannot contain whitespace characters and should use the following naming convention: <STRUCTURE>_<EXTENSIONS>

- ▶ <STRUCTURE>
 - ▶ SIMPLE – contains a unique Panel for CONTEXT
 - ▶ <T><X>PAN – contains several Panels for CONTEXT
 - ▶ <T> – describes the way the Sub-Panels are positioned
 - ▶ H – horizontally
 - ▶ V – vertically
 - ▶ <X> – the number of Sub-Panels defined within the CONTEXT area
 - ▶ When having a complex structure, you can use a combination of <X> and <T> (e.g., 2V3HPAN)
- ▶ <EXTENSIONS>
 - ▶ _TTL – contains a TITLE panel just below the **HEADER** Panel
 - ▶ _FTR – contains a FOOTER panel at the bottom of the screen
 - ▶ _SBH – contains a SUB_HEADER panel below the HEADER and above the TITLE panel (if defined)
 - ▶ _TAB – contains one or more TABS panels, which are dedicated to displaying tabs above the CONTEXT panel(s)
 - ▶ _FLT – contains a FILTERS panel

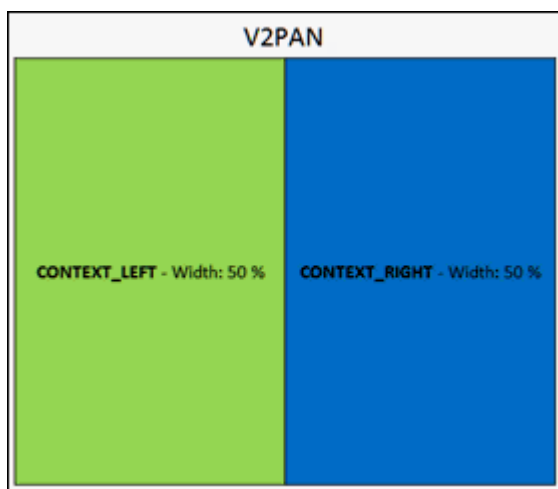
Layout Naming Examples

In the diagrams below:

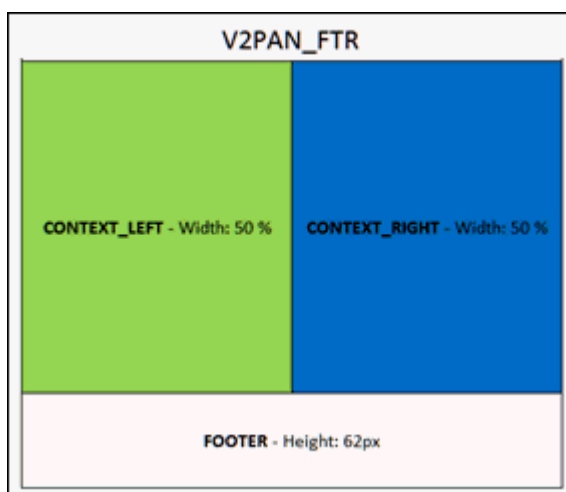
- ▶ SIMPLE_TTL – contains the TITLE, and CONTEXT Panel



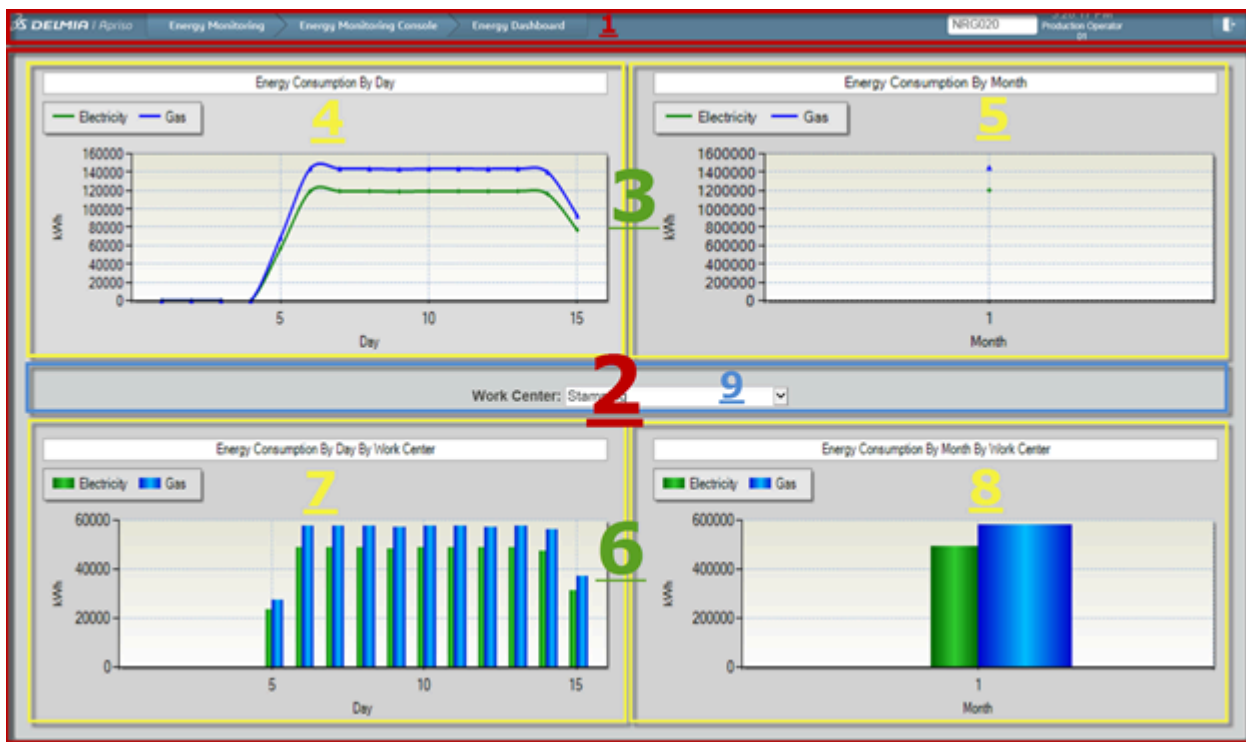
- V2PAN – contains the 2 CONTEXT Panels positioned vertically



- V2PAN_FTR – contains the same as the previous example in addition to a FOOTER Panel at the bottom



Layout Example (V2H2PAN_FLT)



This is the Panel organization and naming for the Layout above:

- ▶ 1 – Header – is always generated on the Screen.
- ▶ 2 – CONTEXT
 - ▷ 3 – CONTEXT_TOP
 - ▶ 4 – CONTEXT_TOP_LEFT
 - ▶ 5 – CONTEXT_TOP_RIGHT
- ▶ 9 – FILTERS
- ▶ 6 – CONTEXT_BOTTOM
 - ▷ 7 – CONTEXT_BOTTOM_LEFT
 - ▷ 8 – CONTEXT_BOTTOM_RIGHT